

Harbourline Energy Co.

Storm Restoration Playbook

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Approved by	Renata Okafor, Director, Distribution Operations
Applies to	Distribution Operations, Forestry, Fleet, Supply Chain, Safety, and all contractor and mutual assistance crews working on the Harbourline system

1. Purpose and Scope

This playbook describes how Harbourline prepares for, responds to and recovers from storms that cause an L3 Major or L4 Emergency outage under OPS-PRO-001 Outage Response Procedure. It covers storm readiness levels, the storm organization, staging areas in each region, mutual assistance, crew work and rest rules, damage assessment, logistics, and demobilization.

The playbook applies in Ontario, New York and Ohio. Where a collective agreement, provincial or state law is more restrictive than this playbook, the more restrictive rule applies.

2. Storm Readiness Levels

The Storm Coordinator Lead reviews the Environment and Climate Change Canada and US National Weather Service forecasts at 06:00 and 15:00 every day and sets the readiness level for each region.

Readiness level	Forecast triggers (any one)	Actions
Green (normal)	No trigger met	Normal on call roster.
Amber (prepare)	Wind gusts of 80 km/h (50 mph) or more; ice accretion of 6 mm (0.25 in) or more; wet snow of 20 cm (8 in) or more; severe thunderstorm watch	Hold crews on standby at shift end; top up fuel at staging areas; confirm contractor availability; confirm hotel blocks.
Red (pre-stage)	Wind gusts of 100 km/h (62 mph) or more; ice accretion of 12 mm (0.5 in) or more; wet snow of 30 cm (12 in) or more; tornado watch	Open staging areas; pre-position crews; place mutual assistance group on alert; activate the Regional EOC 6 hours before forecast onset.

3. Storm Organization

Position	Responsibilities
Storm Coordinator Lead	Overall resource strategy across regions, mutual assistance requests, readiness levels.

Position	Responsibilities
Regional Storm Lead	Runs restoration in one region, assigns crews to work packages, owns the regional ETR.
Logistics Chief	Staging areas, lodging, meals, fuel, material, laundry and sanitation.
Damage Assessment Lead	Assigns patrol teams, consolidates damage reports into work packages.
Safety Officer	Daily safety briefings, incident investigation, work and rest compliance checks.
Mutual Assistance Liaison	Receives incoming crews, runs onboarding, tracks arrival and release.

4. Staging Areas by Region

Each region has a primary staging area and an alternate. The Logistics Chief opens the primary site unless it is unsafe, inaccessible or already at capacity. The active sites for the current storm season are confirmed in the seasonal crew briefing.

Region	Primary staging area	Address	Capacity	Alternate staging area
Eastern Ontario	Kingston Service Centre	1450 Sydenham Road, Kingston ON	40 crews	Napanee Fairgrounds, 4 York Road East lot, Napanee ON
Central Ontario	Barrie Operations Yard	85 Welham Road, Barrie ON	45 crews	Orillia Recreation Centre lot, 255 West Street South, Orillia ON
Durham	Whitby Service Centre	1600 Thickson Road North, Whitby ON	35 crews	Port Perry Fairgrounds, 5 Simcoe Street, Port Perry ON
New York North Country	Watertown Service Center	310 Coffeen Street, Watertown NY	30 crews	St. Lawrence County Fairgrounds, Gouverneur NY
Western New York	Jamestown Operations Yard	92 Harrison Street, Jamestown NY	25 crews	Chautauqua County Fairgrounds, Dunkirk NY
Northeast Ohio	Ashtabula Service Center	2200 Lake Avenue, Ashtabula OH	25 crews	Lake County Fairgrounds, Painesville OH
North Central Ohio	Mansfield Operations Center	700 Park Avenue West, Mansfield OH	30 crews	Ashland County Fairgrounds, Ashland OH

Every staging area must provide: a laydown area for poles and transformers, a fuel point, a secure parking area for at least 20 bucket trucks, portable lighting, sanitation, a check-in tent, and a meal service point able to serve a crew within 30 minutes of arrival.

5. Mutual Assistance

5.1 Membership

Harbourline is a member of the Lakes and Northeast Mutual Assistance Group (LNMAG), which includes utilities in Ontario, Quebec, New York, Pennsylvania, Ohio and Michigan. Requests and offers are made on the LNMAG conference calls, which are held at 10:00 and 16:00 Eastern during an active event.

5.2 When to request

- An L4 Emergency is declared, or
- The projected restoration time exceeds 48 hours for more than 25 percent of affected customers, or
- Available Harbourline and contractor crews are fully committed and the regional ETR exceeds 72 hours.

5.3 Request process

Step 1. The Storm Coordinator Lead prepares a request stating the number of line crews, forestry crews and damage assessors, the reporting staging area, and the expected duration.

Step 2. The VP Operations approves requests for more than 20 crews or with an estimated cost over CAD 500,000.

Step 3. The Storm Coordinator Lead presents the request on the next LNMAG call and confirms offers in writing.

Step 4. The Mutual Assistance Liaison sends each responding utility the staging address, check-in time, lodging details and the onboarding package.

Step 5. For crews crossing the Canada and US border, the Liaison sends the border documentation packet at least 12 hours before departure and notifies the Harbourline customs broker.

5.4 Onboarding and release

Incoming crews complete a 90 minute onboarding at the staging area: Harbourline switching and lockout rules, system voltages and grounding practices, radio channels, and the work and rest rules in Section 6. Crews receive a Harbourline escort (bird dog) for every 4 crews. Crews are released in order of home travel distance, longest distance first, unless the responding utility recalls them earlier. Costs are billed at actual cost under the LNMAG agreement and must be supported by daily time sheets.

6. Crew Work and Rest Rules

Fatigue is a leading contributor to storm injuries. These rules apply to Harbourline employees, contractors and mutual assistance crews alike.

Rule	Requirement
Maximum continuous work	16 consecutive hours, after which the worker must take at least 8 consecutive hours of rest.
Maximum in any 24 hours	16 hours worked in any rolling 24 hour period.
Travel time	Travel to and from lodging and staging counts as work time.

Rule	Requirement
Extension	Up to 18 hours only to complete a task that removes an immediate public safety hazard, approved by the Regional Storm Lead and logged with the reason.
Extended events	After 14 consecutive days of storm duty, a mandatory 24 hour rest period.
Meals	A meal break at least every 5 hours of work.
Fatigue check	The crew leader completes the fatigue checklist at the start of each shift and after any extension.

7. Damage Assessment

Damage assessment patrols start as soon as winds drop below 60 km/h (37 mph) or the Safety Officer declares conditions safe. Target: 100 percent of affected three phase mainline patrolled within 12 hours and 100 percent of laterals within 36 hours. Assessors record broken poles, wires down, damaged transformers and trees on lines in the mobile damage assessment form, with a photo and GPS point for every item.

8. Logistics

- Lodging: one bed per worker, within 45 minutes drive of the assigned staging area where possible.
- Meals: breakfast and dinner at the staging area, packed lunches issued at morning check-out.
- Fuel: staging area fuel points are topped up to at least 75 percent capacity at the start of each shift.
- Material: each staging area holds a storm kit of 30 poles, 20 pole-mount transformers, 5 km of conductor and hardware for 200 spans, replenished nightly from the regional warehouse.

9. Safety During Restoration

- Treat every downed conductor as energized until tested and grounded.
- Watch for backfeed from customer generators; test before touch and ground on both sides of the work.
- All isolation for work follows SAF-MAN-002 Lockout and Tagout Safety Manual; storm conditions do not relax any lockout step.
- A daily tailboard briefing is held before crews leave the staging area and whenever the job changes.

10. Storm Cost Tracking

The Storm Coordinator Lead opens a storm work order for each event in the format STM-YYYY-NNN, for example STM-2026-017. All labour, contractor, mutual assistance, material, fleet, lodging and meal costs are charged to that work order. Storm costs may be subject to recovery requests to the OEB, NY PSC or PUCO, so every charge must be supported by source documents.

11. Demobilization and After Action

Staging areas close when the region falls to L2 or lower and no crews remain assigned. The Logistics Chief returns unused storm kit material within 5 business days. The Storm Coordinator Lead issues the storm After Action Report within 30 calendar days, covering timeline, peak customers out, crews by

source, injuries and near misses, ETR accuracy, and improvement actions.

Revision History

Revision	Date	Author	Summary of changes
3	2023-06-01	D. Hutchins	Added Ohio staging areas.
4	2025-05-20	D. Hutchins	Added border documentation packet requirement.
5	2026-05-15	D. Hutchins	Added Durham staging; clarified 18 hour extension approval.